

EASYCUT

CREATOR PLAYBOOK / 01

ENGLISH / US EDITION

7 Ways to Monetize Short Videos

From a channel that only racks up views to one that actually earns money
2026 EDITION | EASY CUT

AI-generated illustrative creator

36 PAGES / 2026 EDITION

Before You Start

This book does not promise big earnings from Shorts. Instead, it helps you choose one revenue model that fits your situation and provides a step-by-step plan you can test within 30 days.

Platform monetization policies, available features, eligible countries, and requirements can change at any time. Copyright and advertising disclosure obligations vary depending on your content and contracts, so always check the latest official policies and consult an expert before publishing.

Easy Cut is a creation tool designed to help you find material and edit videos. You are responsible for securing rights to original content, people, music, and trademarks, as well as ensuring your content is eligible for platform monetization. Using the tool does not guarantee rights or monetization.

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Contents

Don't rely on ad revenue alone-choose the revenue model that fits your channel.

01 Platform Ad Revenue
How views are directly converted into income
Page 8

02 Affiliate Marketing
Earning commissions from recommended product sales
Page 11

03 Brand Sponsorships
Monetizing your audience and influence with brands
Page 14

04 Selling Your Own Products
Selling ebooks, templates, or courses
Page 17

05 Services & Production
Selling your planning and editing skills
Page 20

06 Memberships & Communities
Recurring income from a loyal core audience
Page 23

07 Long-form & Owned Services
Using Shorts as the entry point for your customer journey
Page 26

Appendix
Revenue Model Selector · 30-Day Action Plan · Performance Tracker · Final Checklist

Why 1 Million Views Doesn’t Always Mean Profit

A million views doesn’t guarantee income.

What matters is where you direct those views.

Many creators believe that high view counts will naturally lead to making money. But while some channels sell products with just 100,000 views, others reach a million views and earn nothing.

The difference is whether you simply collected views or set up a structure to turn those views into revenue. Ad revenue is just one of seven possible methods.

The goal of this book isn’t to get you started on all seven at once. Instead, it helps you pick the one that best fits your channel and guides you through a small-scale test over 30 days.

One Short, Seven Revenue Streams

The results from the same number of views can vary dramatically depending on the revenue path you design.

View-Based
Like platform ad revenue, where high view counts are directly converted into income.

Conversion-Based
Such as affiliate marketing, product sales, or services, where you earn from the viewer’s next action.

Relationship-Based
Like sponsorships or memberships, where you monetize the trust and engagement of specific viewers.

Funnel-Based
Connecting Shorts to long-form videos, newsletters, consultations, or your own services.

Shorts Revenue Map

Start by identifying what you have: audience size, trust, purchase intent, or operational skills.

SHORTS
Entry point for attention

- Platform Ad Revenue
- Affiliate Marketing
- Brand Sponsorships
- Selling Your Own Products
- Services & Production
- Memberships & Paid Communities
- Long-form & Owned Service Connections

Choose only one at a time. Once it’s validated, you can add a second revenue layer.

How to Use This Book

1. Check Your Current Assets
Mark what you already have among views, expertise, products, customers, and community.

2. Choose One Model
Pick just one revenue model that you can validate the fastest.

3. Create 3 Shorts
Make three Shorts with the same offer but different hooks to compare responses.

4. Track Metrics Beyond Views
Record clicks, inquiries, purchases, repeat visits, and churn rate.

5. Decide After 30 Days
Use the numbers to decide whether to continue, revise, or stop.

Record Your Baseline Before Starting
Note the recent average for your last 10 videos: views, profile visits, link clicks, inquiries, purchases, and work hours.

Platform Ad Revenue Overview

METHOD 01
Platform Ad Revenue

Ad revenue is the most familiar way to turn views directly into income, but it's also the slowest to unlock.

Getting Started: Medium Difficulty
First Earnings: Slow
Scalability: High

Key Point of This Chapter
Think of ad revenue not as your starting point, but as a basic income layer that gets added once your channel has grown.

Platform Ad Revenue Details

METHOD 01
Platform Ad Revenue

Platform ad revenue is appealing because you can earn from views without selling your own products. However, you need to meet monetization criteria, pass originality reviews, and your earnings per view depend on ad rates. If you start your channel focusing only on this, it may take a long time to see results.

Revenue Formula
Ad Revenue = Monetizable Views x Revenue Per View

Shorts Feed Ad Requirements: 1,000 subscribers + 10 million valid public Shorts views in the last 90 days

Best For Channels That:
- Can consistently generate high view counts
- Have clear originality, such as self-filmed, narrated, or educational content
- Plan to build a long-term content library

Advantages
- Earn income without selling products or pitching
- Old videos can keep getting views
- Can be combined with other revenue models

Important Limitations
- Takes time to meet monetization requirements
- Earnings per view are not consistent
- Reused or mass-produced content can hurt your channel's review

Policy Reference: YouTube official Help Center, November 2026. Specific requirements may vary by country and account.
TikTok Creator Rewards has separate requirements, such as original videos at least 1 minute long, and availability depends on your region and account.

Action Guide: Platform Ad Revenue

ACTION GUIDE
Step-by-Step Execution and Avoiding Failure

5-Step Execution Order
1. Define a specific viewer problem.
2. Create a format with unique commentary or information.
3. Test at least 5 videos per week, comparing hooks and retention rates.
4. Expand successful topics into a series, but keep content fresh each time.
5. Connect supplementary models like affiliate or services even before monetization is enabled.

Common Mistakes
- Adding only subtitles and backgrounds to someone else's video
- Mass uploading the same template with just different titles
- Focusing only on views and skipping copyright and originality checks

Using Easy Cut
Find trending topics in real time, select segments that make sense on their own, and add your own commentary, comparisons, or opinions.

Easy Cut can save you production time, but it does not guarantee usage rights or monetization suitability.

This Week's Action Task
Create 5 Shorts this week with clear originality, and compare their first 3-second retention and average watch percentage.

Affiliate Marketing Overview

METHOD 02
Affiliate Marketing

Earn commissions when viewers purchase products or services you recommend.

Getting Started: Easy
First Earnings: Fast
Scalability: Moderate

Key Point of This Chapter
It's more important to attract viewers with clear purchase intent than to chase high view counts.

Affiliate Marketing Details

METHOD 02
Affiliate Marketing

You can start affiliate marketing even with a small channel. The key is to naturally connect your video topic with the product. For example, a cooking channel can introduce kitchen tools, or a home recording channel can showcase microphones-presenting products right when viewers are looking for solutions.

Revenue Formula
Affiliate Revenue = Views x Click-Through Rate x Conversion Rate x Commission Per Sale

Best For Channels That:
- Are good at product comparisons and reviews
- Focus on niche topics with high purchase intent
- Can honestly explain tools they've actually used

Advantages
- Can start without creating your own products
- Possible to earn your first income even with few subscribers
- Can quickly test the fit between content and products

Important Limitations
- You need to design a separate flow for link clicks
- Excessive promotion can damage trust
- You must clearly disclose any financial relationships (for example: 'I may earn a commission if you buy through this link.')

Affiliate Marketing: Step-by-Step Action Guide

Step-by-Step Execution (5 Stages)
1. Choose one specific problem and select three related products.
2. List not only the benefits but also who the product may not be suitable for.
3. Write a 30-second script in the order: problem - usage scene - result.
4. Organize your affiliate links in your profile or on a landing page.
5. Track click-through rates and actual purchases, not just views.

Common Mistakes
- Recommending products you haven't used yourself
- Promoting completely unrelated categories in each video
- Hiding or making sponsorship/affiliate disclosures too small

EasyCut Tips
Combine scenes showing real product use, problem explanation, and results to create a short review. Start with the viewer’s problem, not the product name.

This Week’s Action Task
Pick one product that closely matches your channel’s topic and create two informational Shorts and one comparison Short.

US practice example
For a home-office desk demo, compare a product you actually use. Check Amazon Associates US approval, permitted link placements and current terms before using affiliate links. In the video and beside the link, clearly explain any commission or free product. Example arithmetic only: 20,000 views x 1% visits x 3% purchases x $1.20 commission = $7.20 before costs. These are assumed inputs, not typical results or program rates.

Brand Sponsorships: Core Structure

Brand Sponsorships
A sponsorship is not about follower count, but about selling your influence with a specific audience.

Getting Started: Medium difficulty
First Earnings: Medium speed
Scalability: High

Key Point of This Section
Brands are buying more than just a single video-they want access to your precise audience, your credibility, and the rights to use your content.

Brand Sponsorships: How It Works

Even small channels with a clear focus can get sponsorships. Brands look beyond follower numbers. They consider recent average views, quality of comments, how well your audience fits their product, production quality, and potential for controversy.

Revenue Formula
Sponsorship Quote = Production Cost + Channel Exposure Value + Secondary Usage Fee + Exclusivity Terms

Best Fit For
- Channels consistently focused on one field
- Creators who can explain products naturally
- People who can deliver content brands want to reuse

Advantages
- High single-deal payouts possible
- Can lead to long-term partnerships
- Enhances your channel’s expertise and credibility

Important Limitations
- You need results and a portfolio
- Must contractually define revision/review scope
- Must confirm disclosure requirements and secondary usage rights

Brand Sponsorships: Action Guide

Step-by-Step Execution (5 Stages)
1. List 20 brands that fit your channel's theme.
2. Summarize the average performance of your last 10 videos.
3. Create a one-page media kit that brands can quickly understand.
4. Prepare a sample Short where the product appears naturally.
5. Define production scope, posting period, revision count, and usage rights in writing.

Common Mistakes
- Proposals listing only follower count
- Accepting only free products while allowing unlimited revisions and ad use
- Omitting paid partnership or ad disclosures

EasyCut Tips
Quickly create multiple versions of brand samples, testing only the message and first three seconds. Even if the product appears later, show the viewer's problem in the opening scene.

This Week's Action Task
Select 10 brands relevant to your channel and prepare one 15-second sample and a one-page proposal.

Illustrative production-cost estimate: 4 hours x $30 + $20 direct costs = $140, before any negotiated usage rights. This is an internal planning example, not a market quote.

Selling Your Own Products: Core Structure

Selling Your Own Products
This model generates high margins by selling ebooks, templates, courses, or tools.

Getting Started: Medium difficulty
First Earnings: Medium speed
Scalability: Very high

Key Point of This Section
Don’t create a product first. Instead, identify recurring problems in comments and search queries.

Selling Your Own Products: How It Works

Your own products are a powerful revenue model that doesn't depend on platform ad rates. Digital products like ebooks, checklists, prompts, and templates-without shipping costs-can be quickly validated even by small channels.

Revenue Formula
Product Profit = Number of Sales x (Sale Price - Variable Costs - Refund/Payment Fees)

Best Fit For
- Channels that receive repeated questions
- Creators with workflow templates or expertise
- Experts who can guide viewers to specific results

Advantages
- Full control over pricing and content
- Digital products have minimal inventory risk
- You can build your own customer database

Important Limitations
- Products won't sell if you skip problem validation
- You'll need to handle payments, refunds, and customer support
- Too many promotional videos can erode channel trust

Direct Product Sales: Action Guide

Step-by-Step Execution and Avoiding Failure

5-Step Execution Process
1. Collect 20 frequently asked questions from comments or inquiries.
2. Choose the most urgent problem among them.
3. Create a minimum viable product that can be used within 1 hour, rather than a full-scale finished product.
4. Gauge interest with a free preview or checklist.
5. Gather feedback from buyers on their results and use it to improve the next version.

Common Mistakes
- Starting by making the product you want, not what the audience needs
- Focusing only on features and page count
- Making every Short an overt sales pitch

EasyCut Tips
Show part of the solution in your Shorts first, then guide only those who need the full process to your product. For every 4-5 informational Shorts, include about 1 product-connecting content piece.

This Week's Action Task
Collect 10 repeated questions and create a 5-page checklist that solves one of them first.

Service & Production Agency Overview

METHOD 05
Service & Production Agency

This is the fastest way to monetize your Shorts skills by selling your production abilities directly to clients.

Difficulty to Start: Low
Time to First Earnings: Very Fast
Scalability: Medium

Key Point of This Chapter
Even without subscribers, you can generate revenue if you have a portfolio that solves clients' problems.

Service & Production Agency: Details & Limits

You don't have to wait for ad revenue thresholds. You can sell Shorts production, content research, subtitles, uploads, and channel management as a service. Focusing on a specific industry makes it easier to pitch and standardize your workflow.

Revenue Formula
Service Revenue = Number of Clients x Monthly Contract Fee - Outsourcing/Tool/Revision Costs

Best Suited For
- Those who can quickly provide editing and planning
- Those with few subscribers but strong deliverables to show
- Operators looking to deeply understand a specific industry

Advantages
- Fastest path to first revenue
- Can secure inquiries even with low view counts
- Client experience can expand into future products and courses

Important Limitations
- Your time and workforce can cap your revenue
- Unclear revision policies can lead to losses
- You must confirm copyright and publishing rights with clients

Service & Production Agency: Action Guide

Step-by-Step Execution and Avoiding Failure

5-Step Execution Process
1. Choose one industry (e.g., music, healthcare, real estate).
2. Create 3 sample Shorts.
3. Clearly define your package by number, length, and revision count.
4. Confirm original content usage rights before production.
5. Track your work time and automate low-profit steps.

Common Mistakes
- Advertising that you serve all industries
- Offering unlimited revisions
- Promising guaranteed view counts
- Managing client accounts and originals without a contract

EasyCut Tips
Quickly propose multiple candidate segments and titles from a single long-form video, then render only the approved segments. Save client-specific templates and banned phrases to reduce repetitive work.

This Week's Action Task
Pick one industry and create three sample Shorts-one informational, one twist, and one Q&A style-from the same original content.

Memberships & Paid Communities Overview

METHOD 06
Memberships & Paid Communities

This model provides ongoing value to a loyal few, rather than chasing high view counts.

Difficulty to Start: Medium
Time to First Earnings: Medium
Scalability: High

Key Point of This Chapter
Memberships sell the recurring results members get each month, not just the amount of content.

Memberships & Paid Communities: Details & Limits

Memberships can generate steady monthly income, but you need both a reason for people to join and a reason for them to stay. Instead of just stockpiling resources, focus on recurring value like regular feedback, curated information, or scheduled action plans.

Revenue Formula
Monthly Recurring Revenue = Number of Paid Members x Monthly Price - Platform/Operating Costs

Best Suited For
- Channels with steady questions and comments
- Fields where you can provide new info or feedback weekly
- Those who excel at deep, small-group communication

Advantages
- Predictable recurring income
- Direct communication with loyal customers
- Quickly validate ideas for products and services

Important Limitations
- You must maintain value every month
- Community management and support are required
- Platform and regional features may vary

Memberships & Paid Communities: Action Guide

Step-by-Step Execution and Failure Prevention

5-Step Execution Order:
1. Write a single sentence describing the result members will get each month.
2. Decide on weekly deliverables and monthly events.
3. Clearly define the boundary between free content and paid benefits.
4. Get direct feedback from your first 20 members and improve accordingly.
5. Focus on churn and engagement rates rather than just subscriber numbers.

Common Pitfalls:
- Having lots of materials but no clear order of use
- No onboarding process after sign-up
- Paid channel feels too similar to the free one

EasyCut Tips:
- Offer weekly trend briefings, title templates, and member-only analytics.
- Produce Shorts quickly and deliver them on the same day each week so subscribers can anticipate the rhythm.

This Week's Action Task:
Reduce your monthly benefits to three core offerings and interview ten people about their interest in joining and the results they want.

Long-Form & Owned Service Funnel Overview

METHOD 07
Connecting Shorts to Long-Form & Owned Services

Use Shorts not as the final product, but as an entry point to build deeper relationships.

Difficulty to Start: Medium
First Revenue Speed: Medium
Scalability: Very High

Key Point of This Chapter:
Shorts generate interest; long-form videos and landing pages build trust and help finalize purchase decisions.

Connecting Shorts to Long-Form & Services: Details

Short videos are great for discovery, but have limitations when it comes to complex explanations or selling high-priced products. After highlighting a problem in a Short, connect viewers to long-form content, newsletters, free resources, consultations, or SaaS offerings. This can turn a single view into a customer relationship.

Revenue Formula:
Funnel Revenue = Shorts Traffic x Transition Rate x Conversion Rate x Customer Value

Best For:
- Those running a long-form channel or website
- Products that require explanation (consulting, courses, SaaS)
- Businesses wanting to build long-term customer relationships

Advantages:
- Potential for higher customer value than ad revenue
- Multiple content pieces become a unified business asset
- Reduced dependence on platform changes

Important Limitations:
- Complicated transition paths can lead to drop-off
- If the message in the Short and the landing page differ, conversions drop
- Running all channels from the start can dilute your focus

Long-Form Funnel: Action Guide

Step-by-Step Execution and Failure Prevention

5-Step Execution Order:
1. Choose only one destination after the Short.
2. Provide a reason for the next action, such as a free resource or long-form content.
3. Match the first sentence of the Short and the landing page.
4. Measure conversions after link clicks.
5. Expand into a series with topics that show high conversion rates.

Common Pitfalls:
- Repeatedly asking for link clicks in every video
- Asking viewers to take multiple actions in one Short
- Focusing only on views, not tracking transition or purchase rates

EasyCut Tips:
- Use the strongest problem statement and cliffhanger from your long-form content to create a Short, then deliver the full solution in the connected content. This isn't about clickbait-clearly promise the value of the next step.

This Week's Action Task:
Connect three Shorts to just one destination (long-form, free resource, or consultation page) and compare transition rates.

Monetization Safety: Four Key Risks

Four Risks That Can Block Monetization

01. Copyright
Make sure you have the rights to use original videos, music, photos, and characters. Simply crediting the source does NOT grant you usage rights.

02. Reused Content
Videos that only add subtitles, backgrounds, or cropping may not be considered meaningfully original. Your own commentary and structure must be clear.

03. Mass-Produced Content
If you mass-produce content by changing only the topic while using the same template and narration, it can hurt your channel's authenticity and monetization review.

04. Disclosure of Ads
If you have an economic interest (cash, free products, affiliate commissions), make it obvious to viewers. FTC guidelines require clear disclosure, such as: 'I may earn a commission if you buy through this link.' Platform labels alone may not be enough.

References: YouTube Channel Monetization Policies · Meta Branded Content Guidelines · FTC Endorsement Guides

Choosing Your Monetization Model

Pick the Model That Fits You

Choose the line that best matches your current assets:

Current Situation → Recommended Model → First Steps
- Lots of views but no product → Platform Ad Revenue → Originality & consistent uploads
- Few subscribers but strong expertise → Services/Production → 3 samples & clear packages
- Good at product comparisons/reviews → Affiliate Marketing → Topics with high purchase intent
- Frequently asked the same questions → Your Own Product → A minimal product solving one problem
- Small but loyal audience → Memberships → Repeatable monthly results
- Consistent exposure in a niche → Brand Sponsorships → Media kit & licensing terms
- Have long-form, website, or service → Funnel Connection → One clear next destination

Selection Rule:
Don't pick the model that just looks impressive-choose one where you can see real feedback within 30 days.

30-Day Plan: Weeks 1-2

WEEK 1
Decide on Revenue Structure
1. Define your channel topic and primary audience in one sentence.
2. Choose one revenue model.
3. Research the revenue paths of 10 competing channels.
4. Record baseline data for your latest 10 videos.
5. Set one clear next destination for viewers after your Shorts.

WEEK 2
Test 7 Shorts
1. Collect 20 trending topics from Easy Cut.
2. Create 2-3 hooks for 3 of those topics.
3. Use only one call to action per video.
4. Track the first 3 seconds retention, completion rate, and comments for each video.
5. Compare clicks, inquiries, and saves-not just views.

30-Day Plan: Weeks 3-4

WEEK 3
Connect Revenue Pathways
1. Prepare affiliate links, products, or consultation pages.
2. Standardize your profile and description text.
3. Clearly disclose ads and affiliate relationships.
4. Post 3 Shorts with calls to action included.
5. Check for missed webhooks, inquiries, or orders.

WEEK 4
Analyze Results and Decide
1. Select the top 3 topics with the highest conversion rates.
2. Calculate revenue compared to your working hours.
3. Identify and fix one cause of low conversions.
4. Decide whether to continue, adjust, or stop.
5. Secure 20 new topics for next month's content.

Performance Tracking Sheet

Beyond Views: Performance Tracking
Discovery
Views · Reach
Did your topic and hook generate interest?

Watch
3-second retention · Completion rate
Did your video structure keep viewers engaged?

Interest
Saves · Shares · Comments
Did viewers find it worth revisiting or discussing?

Action
Profile visits · Link clicks
Was the reason for the next step clear?

Conversion
Inquiries · Purchases · Sign-ups
Did your revenue structure actually work?

Efficiency
Production time · Costs · Profit
Is it worth repeating?

Decision Criteria
If you get clicks and purchases even with low views, keep going. If you get lots of views but no further action, revise your CTA and landing page.

Final Checklist Before Posting Revenue Shorts

10-Point Checklist Before Posting
01. Can you explain in one sentence whose problem this video addresses and what it solves?
02. Does the first 3 seconds show a problem, twist, or result?
03. Have you checked the rights for all video, audio, and images used?
04. If you used someone else's content, did you add meaningful commentary and a new structure?
05. Did you avoid repeating the same template with only the content changed?
06. Is there only one action you ask viewers to take?
07. Does the promise in your Shorts match the content on the landing page?
08. Did you disclose any affiliate, sponsorship, or free product relationships?
09. Can you measure clicks, inquiries, or purchases-not just views?
10. Have you identified one thing to change if results are low?

If you check fewer than 8 items
This doesn't mean you should delay posting. Instead, fix one missing item and run a small test to see how viewers respond.

You Don't Need a Million Views for Your First Revenue

What matters is knowing who is watching and making it clear where they should go next after watching your Shorts.

Today's Task
Pick one revenue model, and create three Shorts with the same offer but different hooks.

Spot trends early and claim your space with Shorts.

Official sources

Open a title to read the official guidance. Recheck current terms before applying or publishing.

1. YouTube Partner Program monetization features and criteria

support.google.com

2. YouTube Channel Monetization Policies - Reused & Mass-Produced Content

support.google.com

3. TikTok Creator Rewards Program

support.tiktok.com

4. Instagram Branded Content and Paid Partnership Disclosure

facebook.com

5. Instagram Monetization Features

facebook.com

6. FTC Disclosures 101 for Social Media Influencers (US)

ftc.gov